

SENATE BILL 1354

By Akbari

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 33;
Title 63 and Title 68, relative to suicide.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 33, Chapter 1, Part 3, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

- (a) The department shall develop and implement a suicide prevention program.
- (b) The program must:
 - (1) Support upstream comprehensive community-based suicide prevention;
 - (2) Conduct positive interventions with persons who have threatened or attempted suicide;
 - (3) Partner with local organizations to implement such program in communities;
 - (4) Conduct research on suicide rates among diverse populations;
 - (5) Conduct research on how to reduce the access of lethal means among persons at risk of suicide; and
 - (6) Implement postvention support for a person who has attempted suicide and for such person's family.
- (c) The department is encouraged to collaborate with qualified mental health professionals in the development and implementation of this program.
- (d) On or before January 1 of each year, the department shall submit a report to the health and welfare committee of the senate and the committee of the house of

representatives having jurisdiction over health-related matters on this program and any suggestions from the department based upon the research conducted from the previous calendar year.

(e) The department is authorized to promulgate rules to effectuate this section.

The rules must be promulgated in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5.

SECTION 2. For the purposes of promulgating rules, this act takes effect upon becoming law, the public welfare requiring it. For all other purposes, this act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it.